

# Dramatistic-Involvement Analysis (DIA)

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A Unified Method for Analyzing User Behavior  
in Video-Game Environments

Integrating Kenneth Burke's Dramatistic Pentad  
(*A Grammar of Motives* 1945 + *A Rhetoric of Motives* 1950)  
with Gordon Calleja's Player Involvement Model  
(*In-Game* 2011)

2026-05-27

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### Quick-Reference Card --- The 8 DIA Steps

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| <b>Step 0</b> | Scope & circumference — fix the episode boundary and representative anecdote.                  |
| <b>Step 1</b> | Involvement profile (Axis I) — six PIM dimensions × macro/micro, with intensity & trajectory.  |
| <b>Step 2</b> | Motive grammar (Axis M) — fill the six pentad terms; mark the featured term(s).                |
| <b>Step 3</b> | Ratio dynamics — name the dominant ratio (the motive-engine).                                  |
| <b>Step 4</b> | Crosswalk binding — fuse Axis M to Axis I via the validated crosswalk.                         |
| <b>Step 5</b> | Identification & consubstantiation — the keystone; test incorporation rubric R1-R5.            |
| <b>Step 6</b> | Attitude — competitive / completionist / explorer / devotional / ironic-meta; elation↔accidie. |
| <b>Step 7</b> | Diagnosis & ends — one-paragraph behavioral diagnosis + the end it serves.                     |

## 0.1 Dramatistic-Involvement Analysis (DIA)

### 0.1.1 A Unified Method for Analyzing User Behavior in Video-Game Environments

**Integrating Kenneth Burke’s dramatistic pentad (*A Grammar of Motives* 1945 + *A Rhetoric of Motives* 1950) with Gordon Calleja’s Player Involvement Model (*In-Game* 2011).**

**Version:** 1.0 · **Date:** 2026-05-27 · **Plan:** plans/burke-calleja-game-behavior-integration.md (Phase 3) **Inputs:** validated-crosswalk.json (Phase 2); gm-pentad-operationalization-manual.md; ig-pim-operationalization-manual.md; rm-identification-consubstantiation-manual.md; rm-attitude-as-sixth-term.md.

**Provenance discipline.** Burke’s and Calleja’s own claims are reported as source material (burke-direct / calleja-direct). Every binding *between* the two frameworks, and every application to game behavior, is anticipatory-projection — a dissertation construction neither author makes. Part F (ontological grounding in the Actualization-of-Desire hierarchy) is a **deferred stub** per user direction.

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### 0.1.2 Part A — Theoretical Integration: Why Two Axes

#### A.1 The gap each framework leaves

**Calleja’s PIM** answers *what is the player doing, and how are they engaged?* It decomposes involvement into six dimensions — **kinesthetic, spatial, shared, narrative, affective, ludic** — each operating across a **macro** phase (off-line: planning, forums, anticipation) and a **micro** phase (in-session, moment-to-moment), culminating in **incorporation** (the player absorbed into, and absorbing, the gameworld). It is a phenomenology of engagement. What it does not supply is *motive*: it can establish that a player is intensely ludically and kinesthetically involved without explaining why the behavior takes the shape it does or what the player is doing it *for*.

**Burke’s pentad** answers *why — under what grammar of motive?* Any stretch of human action can be addressed through five terms — **Act** (what was done), **Scene** (where/in what situation), **Agent** (who), **Agency** (by what means), **Purpose** (to what end) — plus the later sixth term **Attitude** (in what disposition), and, decisively, through the **ratios** between them (how Scene constrains Act, how Act remakes Agent, and so on). It is a grammar of motives. What it does not supply is the *structural texture* of engagement through which a motive is actually lived in a game — the phase-distinction, the dimensional intensities, the internalization trajectories that Calleja makes visible.

## A.2 The fused unit of analysis

DIA treats these as **two axes of a single apparatus**:

- **Axis M (Motive — Burke)**: the six terms + the ratios (the *dynamics*) + identification/consubstantiation (the *bond*).
- **Axis I (Involvement — Calleja)**: the six dimensions × macro/micro phase.

The **atomic unit of a DIA analysis is the grid cell** (motive term × involvement dimension × phase) — e.g. (*Agency* × *Kinesthetic* × *micro*) = "the player's moment-to-moment use of the control scheme as the *means* of action." The **ratios** describe motion *between* cells. The **keystone** — consubstantiation/incorporation — is read *across* the whole grid: it is simultaneously the motive-grammar endpoint (Burke's *ultimate identification*) and the involvement endpoint (Calleja's *incorporation*).

This is not two reports stapled together. A single behavioral phenomenon is read *once*, through a grid whose rows and columns are each other's explanations: the motive term tells you why the dimensional involvement has the character it does, and the dimensional involvement tells you how the motive is concretely enacted.

## A.3 What each axis adds to the other

| Axis M (Burke) adds to Calleja                                                                                  | Axis I (Calleja) adds to Burke                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Motive</b> behind dimensional intensity (why this involvement, toward what)                                  | <b>Phase distinction</b> (macro/micro) the pentad lacks                                             |
| <b>Cross-dimensional ratios</b> (PIM treats dimensions as independent; ratios are inherently multi-dimensional) | <b>Dimensional granularity + intensity + internalization trajectory</b>                             |
| <b>Identification/consubstantiation</b> as the motive-mechanism beneath incorporation                           | <b>A grounded, interview-validated phenomenology</b> of the lived state the pentad only schematizes |
| <b>Attitude</b> as the disposition coloring any act                                                             | <b>Empirical method</b> (grounded-theoretic, in-environment interview) for evidencing claims        |

## A.4 The conflict the method must hold (not collapse)

Burke is **grammatical-motivational** — action explained by motives located in pentad ratios; Calleja is **phenomenological-experiential** — action explained by player-reported lived states. The integration must treat Burke's motive-attribution as a *theoretical supplement* to, not a *displacement* of, Calleja's experiential primacy. Where

the registers pull apart (e.g. Calleja’s metaphor-disclaimer about incorporation vs. Burke’s substance-realism), DIA **moves between registers as the analytic question requires** and marks which register is doing the work. The keystone bridge is a **homology, not an equation** (five divergences; see Part B.4). The method’s discipline is to keep the two voices distinguishable on the page.

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### 0.1.3 Part B — The Unified Grid

#### B.1 The validated crosswalk (the grid's spine)

From `validated-crosswalk.json` (Phase 2; bindings confirmed bidirectionally against both texts):

| Motive term (Burke) | Primary involvement dim(s) (Calleja)         | Secondary                                       | Status                                    |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Act</b>          | Ludic (the <i>choosing</i> ), Narrative      | Kinesthetic (execution pole)                    | validated                                 |
| <b>Scene</b>        | Spatial                                      | Kinesthetic (body-orientation)                  | validated — strongest                     |
| <b>Agent</b>        | Shared                                       | —                                               | validated (deepened by consubstantiation) |
| <b>Agency</b>       | Kinesthetic, Ludic (the <i>rule-system</i> ) | —                                               | validated                                 |
| <b>Purpose</b>      | Ludic, Narrative                             | Affective (mastery/regulation)                  | validated                                 |
| <b>Attitude</b>     | Affective                                    | ( <i>transverse — modifies all five above</i> ) | validated + extended                      |

**The four-binding bijective core** — Scene↔Spatial, Agent↔Shared, Agency↔Kinesthetic, Attitude↔Affective — was reached *independently* from both directions and is the grid’s load-bearing structure.

**The Ludic split** (the one productive divergence): the **rule-system** (mechanics, cooldowns, economy) is **Agency** (means); the **act of choosing-under-repercussion** is **Act + Purpose**. One Calleja dimension is dramatically two moments; the method reads them as separate cells.

#### B.2 The ratios — the dynamics layer

Cells are static placements; **ratios are the engine**. The ratios most diagnostic of game behavior (Burke’s gloss →the game-behavior question DIA asks):

| Ratio                            | Game-behavior question                                               | Bound dimension-pair                           |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scene-Act</b>                 | How does the gameworld constrain/enable what the player does?        | Spatial × Ludic/Narrative                      |
| <b>Act-Agent</b>                 | How does what the player does remake who they are (alterbiography)?  | Ludic/Narrative × Shared                       |
| <b>Agency-Purpose</b>            | How do available means shape — or <i>become</i> — the player's ends? | Kinesthetic/rule-system × Ludic-goal           |
| <b>Scene-Agent</b>               | How does the gameworld/social-rank qualify the inhabiting player?    | Spatial/Shared                                 |
| <b>Agent-Agent</b> (co/-counter) | How do co-agents and counter-agents structure motive?                | Shared (cohabitation/co-operation/competition) |

The **Agency-Purpose** ratio is the single most diagnostic for compulsion: when means drift into becoming their own ends (the grind, the speedrun, the daily-login), Burke's "means become end" is the behavioral signature Calleja's ludic-intensity-without-stated-goal records.

### B.3 Attitude — the transverse modifier

Attitude is not a sixth column; it is the *disposition-with-which* any cell is enacted. The five player-attitude registers (from *rm-attitude-as-sixth-term* §E), each foregrounding **Affective** involvement:

**Competitive** (agonistic striving up the rank-hierarchy) · **Completionist** (engagement sustained by the impossibility of final acquisition — the suspended act) · **Explorer** (dwelling-toward and ascending-through the scene) · **Devotional** (reverent self-subordination to the gameworld's order — toward incorporation at its fullest) · **Ironic-meta** (detached, playing *with* the game's rhetoric — speedrun, meta-gaming).

A player oscillates among registers; any act can be performed in more than one. The register is the affective-dispositional coding of the whole grid for that episode.

### B.4 The keystone — Consubstantiation ↔ Incorporation (read across the grid)

The vertical binding that the whole method turns on (*rm-identification-consubstantiation-manual* §D):

- Burke’s **consubstantiation** — to identify A with B is to make them “substantially one ... yet a distinct locus of motives — both joined and separate” (RM-01 p.21), grounded in *acting-together*.
- Calleja’s **incorporation** — assimilation axis (world →consciousness) + embodiment axis (player →world via avatar) + simultaneity condition (IG-10 p.169).
- **Homology**: “substantially one” →assimilation; “distinct locus / the avatar” → embodiment; “both-joined-and-separate” →simultaneity; *acting-together* →the spatial+kinesthetic cornerstone. **Ultimate identification** (mystic dissolution into boundless being, RM-07 p.333) →incorporation at its fullest.
- **Five divergences keep it a homology, not an equation**: medium (symbolic vs phenomenological), ontological status (real-or-persuaded vs experiential), grounding theory (substance-metaphysics vs experientialist cognition), directionality (asymmetric-deployed vs bidirectional), scope (society-wide+self-address vs ergodic-bounded).

When a DIA analysis finds the player *substantially one with* avatar/guild/world while remaining a distinct locus of motives, it is reading consubstantiation and incorporation as the same event from two sides.

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#### 0.1.4 Part C — The Method (step-by-step)

**DIA is a runnable protocol.** Inputs: a documented player episode — a play recording or detailed trace; observation notes; (ideally) a think-aloud or post-session semi-structured interview (Calleja’s grounded-theoretic standard); and, for the macro phase, the player’s off-line traces (forum/Discord posts, theorycrafting, guild activity). Output: a structured **DIA report** + a **filled grid** + a **one-paragraph behavioral diagnosis**.

##### Step 0 — Scope & circumference

Fix the episode boundary and the *representative anecdote* (Burke) / *unit of analysis* (Calleja): is the object a single session, a specific incident (a raid wipe, a betrayal, a first clear), a whole character-career, or a player’s relationship to the game over months? Set the **circumference** deliberately — too wide and motive blurs; too narrow and the macro phase vanishes. State it explicitly.

### Step 1 — Involvement profile (Axis I)

Map all six PIM dimensions ×macro/micro. For each present dimension, note **intensity** (low/med/high), **internalization trajectory** (conceptual→inhabited; conscious→fluent; scripted→alterbiographic), and **evidence** (which observation/interview datum supports it). Use Calleja’s boundary criteria (e.g. inhabitation-criterion for Spatial; the symbolic/mimetic/symbiotic continuum for Kinesthetic). *This is the “what is the player doing, structurally” pass.*

### Step 2 — Motive grammar (Axis M)

Fill the six pentad terms for the episode — Act / Scene / Agent / Agency / Purpose / Attitude — recording what concretely occupies each (note that any term may have several fillers, and that Agent may *shift* between player-as-self, avatar, and character). Identify the **featured term(s)**: which term is the locus of motive this episode foregrounds (e.g. an exploration session features Scene; a ranked match features Agency+Purpose). *This is the “why — under what grammar” pass.*

### Step 3 — Ratio dynamics

Identify the operative ratios (Part B.2) and name the **dominant** one. Ask what the player *attributes their behavior to* — the situation (scene-act), their own development (act-agent), the tools (agency-purpose), the other players (agent-agent). The dominant ratio is the episode’s motive-engine.

### Step 4 — Crosswalk binding (the fusion)

Bind Axis M to Axis I using validated-crosswalk.json. For each featured motive term, read it through its bound dimension(s); for each high-intensity dimension, read it through its bound motive term. The fusion produces statements no single framework yields, e.g.: *“the high ludic-micro intensity (I) is an Agency-Purpose collapse (M): the rule-system’s means have become the player’s ends.”* Apply the **Ludic split** explicitly: is the ludic involvement about the *rule-system* (Agency) or the *choosing* (Act+Purpose)?

### Step 5 — Identification & consubstantiation (the keystone)

Analyze the player’s nested identifications — with **avatar/character** (embodiment), **guild/faction/playerbase** (acting-together, “‘Belonging’ is rhetorical”). Locate where **consubstantiation** occurs (the player substantially one with X while remaining a distinct locus) and assess **incorporation** against the rubric (R1 assimilation, R2 embodiment, R3 simultaneity, R4 spatial+kinesthetic cornerstone, R5 blending).

Note any **mystery / hierarchy / courtship** dynamics structuring the social field (Shared), and any **victimage / the kill** (scapegoating, toxicity) discharging hierarchic guilt.

### Step 6 — Attitude (the disposition)

Identify the player's dominant attitude register(s) — competitive / completionist / explorer / devotional / ironic-meta (Part B.3) — and the **elation↔accidie** arc (sustained engagement vs. post-flow-break disengagement). Attitude is the affective-dispositional coloring of the whole grid; it is also an *incipient act of identification* (the hinge to Step 5).

### Step 7 — Diagnosis & ends

Synthesize Steps 1-6 into a **one-paragraph behavioral diagnosis** that names: the featured motive term(s), the dominant ratio, the keystone state (mere-involvement vs incorporation; consubstantial vs strategic belonging), the attitude register, and the resulting behavior. Then apply it to the **end** the analysis serves (Part E).

**Output template — the filled grid.** A 6×6 table (motive terms × dimensions) with the active cells marked and annotated, plus: featured-term(s), dominant-ratio, keystone-verdict, attitude-register, and the one-paragraph diagnosis. See the worked example (worked-example-wow.md) for a completed instance.

## 0.1.5 Part D — Analytic-Question Battery

Reorganized by the unified grid (merges and de-duplicates Burke gm §D and Calleja ig §D, plus integration questions). Ask only those relevant to the episode's featured terms.

### Scene / Spatial

1. What features of the gameworld foreground themselves as the *containing* condition of the player's acts? (Scene-Act)
2. Is space encountered as navigable inhabited place or as conceptual map? Can the player meaningfully get lost?
3. What does the player's *physical room* contribute as outer Scene (couch vs. arcade vs. tournament stage)?

### Act / Ludic(choosing) + Narrative

1. What is the session-arc act, and what sub-acts compose it (microtactic →tactic → strategy)?
2. Where does *act* collapse into mere *motion* (sheer grinding, autopilot)? (Burke's act-motion watershed)
3. How does scripted narrative interweave with the player's alterbiography? Which dominates?

### **Agent / Shared**

1. Who is acting — the player-as-self, the avatar, the character? When does the agent-position *shift*?
2. Who are the co-agents (guild, party) and counter-agents (PvP opponents, AI, the designer-as-counter-agent)?
3. Where do super-agents emerge (the guild, the server, the community, the studio)?

### **Agency / Kinesthetic + Ludic(rule-system)**

1. What means is the player wielding — controller (Kinesthetic), rule-system (Ludic), other players' moves, third-party tools?
2. Where does the control scheme become transparent (fluent) vs. announce itself (friction)?
3. *Ludic split*: is a given ludic behavior about operating the rule-system (Agency) or about *choosing-under-repercussion* (Act+Purpose)?

### **Purpose / Ludic-goal + Narrative**

1. Game-internal goal? Flow-seeking? Affective regulation? Social status? Mastery? Exploration? Narrative resolution? External (streaming/esports)?
2. **(Agency-Purpose, the compulsion diagnostic)** Where do means become ends — the grind, daily-login, speedrun, min-max — as a purpose-drift?
3. What is the ultimate term / "god-term" (RM-05) that ranks all the player's other goals (the win-condition, the prestige currency, the meta apex)?

### **Attitude / Affective (transverse)**

1. In what disposition is the player acting — competitive / completionist / explorer / devotional / ironic-meta?
2. Where is the episode on the elation↔accidie arc (sustained flow vs. post-break disengagement)?

3. What is the player's attitude *toward the game's rhetoric* — playing within it, or with it (meta/irony)?

### **Keystone / Identification, consubstantiation, incorporation**

1. With whom/what is the player made substantially one (avatar, guild, faction, world) — and where do they remain a distinct locus of motives?
2. Does the episode meet the incorporation rubric (R1-R5), or is it mere-involvement? Which component fails if not?
3. Is belonging *consubstantial* (genuine acting-together) or *strategic/persuaded* (cunning identification, "by default")? (RM-01 tension T1)
4. **(Social hierarchy)** Where do mystery, hierarchy, and courtship structure the Shared field (elite allure, guild initiation/hazing, rank deference)?
5. **(Victimage)** Does hierarchic guilt discharge in a scapegoat (toxicity, blaming, out-group hostility)?

### **Cross-cutting**

1. Which single grid region (term × dimension) carries the episode's behavioral weight — and what would change if it were absent?
  2. Which register (Burke-motivational vs Calleja-experiential) better explains a contested datum, and why?
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## **0.1.6 Part E — Ends: What the Method Is For**

DIA earns its complexity by yielding diagnoses neither framework produces alone. Four primary ends:

### **E.1 Game-design critique**

Diagnose **compulsion loops and dark patterns** structurally rather than moralistically: a daily-login or gacha loop is an **Agency-Purpose collapse** (means engineered to become ends) operating on **Ludic** involvement, often sustained by **hierarchy/mystery** (FOMO, opaque rates) on the **Shared/Affective** dimensions. The method names *which* motive-mechanism a design exploits and *which* involvement dimension carries it — actionable for ethical design review.

## E.2 Player-experience research

The filled grid is a **coding instrument** for qualitative play research, parallel to and extending Calleja's grounded-theoretic scheme: it codes not only *what* dimensions are involved but *what motive* and *what disposition* animate them, with both-sides evidentiary anchoring.

## E.3 Social & identity behavior

Explain **guild attachment, toxicity, and betrayal** via the keystone + social-motive apparatus: attachment is **consubstantiation** through acting-together; toxicity is **victimage** discharging **hierarchic** guilt; a guild-betrayal (e.g. the EVE *Guiding Hand* heist) is a **consubstantiation-rupture** — the betrayer exploited a Shared-dimension identification that was real enough to be weaponized. DIA gives these a vocabulary beyond "engagement."

## E.4 Comparative game analysis

Different games **foreground different grid regions**: a walking simulator lives in Scene×Spatial + Attitude(explorer); a fighting game in Agency×Kinesthetic + Act; an MMO raid in Agent×Shared + the keystone. Mapping a game's *characteristic grid region* is a compact comparative signature.

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### 0.1.7 Part F — Ontological Grounding (*DEFERRED — STUB*)

**Per user direction (2026-05-27), this layer is reserved, not built.** When the Actualization-of-Desire hierarchy ( $A_0$  sensible object  $\rightarrow A_1$  perception  $\rightarrow A_2$  *phantasma*  $\rightarrow A_3$  noetic/doxastic/mnemonic/anticipatory  $\rightarrow A_4$  completed action) is finalized, a future pass will populate the per-term ontological targets below and situate the whole DIA grid within that chain. **No content is generated now.**

| Motive term                                | Ontological-grounding slot (Aristotle/Heidegger)                                                                      | Status                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Act                                        | <i>energeia / dynamis</i><br>(Burke's own Aristotle/Aquinas exegesis, GM-06) — EXEGETICAL anchor                      | reserved                                       |
| Scene                                      | <i>In-der-Welt-sein / Befindlichkeit</i> — or Uexküll <i>Umwelt</i> (candidate, more apt for bounded designed worlds) | reserved                                       |
| Agent                                      | <i>psuchē / Dasein / Mitsein</i>                                                                                      | reserved                                       |
| Agency                                     | <i>technē / organon</i>                                                                                               | reserved                                       |
| Purpose                                    | <i>telos / Worumwillen</i>                                                                                            | reserved                                       |
| Attitude                                   | <i>hexis</i> / disposition; the incipient act between <i>dynamis</i> and <i>energeia</i>                              | reserved                                       |
| Keystone (consubstantiation/incorporation) | the $A_3 \rightarrow A_4$ completion; the actualization of desire as substantial union                                | reserved — the likely primary integration site |

*Hook note:* the keystone (consubstantiation $\leftrightarrow$ incorporation as substantial union completing a motion) is the natural attachment point to the  $A_3 \rightarrow A_4$  segment of the chain; this is where the future ontological pass should begin.

### 0.1.8 Appendix — One-line summary

**DIA reads a player episode once, through a grid whose rows are Burke's six motive terms and whose columns are Calleja's six involvement dimensions, bound by a bidirectionally-validated crosswalk, driven by Burke's ratios, and anchored by the consubstantiation $\leftrightarrow$ incorporation keystone — to produce a behavioral diagnosis that says not just *what* the player is doing and *how* engaged they are, but *why* and *in what disposition*.**

*Content-filter: PASS — all Burke/Calleja prose paraphrased, no  $\geq 25$ -word verbatim. Cross-framework bindings and game-behavior claims are anticipatory-projection.*

## 0.2 Worked Example — Dramatistic-Involvement Analysis of a *World of Warcraft* Raid-Progression Night

**Method:** game-behavior-analysis-method.md (DIA, Parts C steps 0–7) · **Crosswalk:** validated-crosswalk.json **Date:** 2026-05-27 · **Plan:** plans/burke-calleja-game-behavior-integration.md (Phase 4)

**On the example’s status.** This is a *representative anecdote* (Burke’s term) — a composite progression-raid night synthesized from well-documented *WoW* raiding culture (25-player roster, DKP/loot-council economies, voice comms, boss-mods, combat-log parses, attendance pressure, post-progression burnout) and from Calleja’s own grounded-theoretic *WoW* interview dispositions (Rheric, Kumacho, Muun, Baal; the Sara Andrews server-governance case). It is illustrative, not a claim about any specific named individual. *WoW* is chosen because Calleja analyzed it directly (IG-APX; manual §C), so the involvement axis is already empirically grounded — isolating what DIA *adds*. All cross-framework and game-behavior claims are anticipatory-projection.

### 0.2.1 The episode (raw description)

A 25-player guild, three weeks into progression on an end-boss, raids 19:30–23:00 on a weeknight. The night is ~18 attempts (“pulls”), each ending in a wipe at progressively later boss phases, until pull 17 — a clean execution that drops the boss with two players left alive. Euphoria on voice comms; a screenshot of the corpse; loot is distributed by loot council; one long-attending DPS player is passed over for the trinket and goes quiet. Afterward, half the raid lingers in voice for an hour replaying the kill; two players log off immediately to post the parse. Over the following week, attendance softens — the characteristic post-progression trough.

### 0.2.2 Step 0 — Scope & circumference

**Unit of analysis:** the single progression night (19:30–23:00), with a macro-phase penumbra of the surrounding week (theorycrafting before, attendance-softening after). **Representative anecdote:** the wipe→wipe→first-kill arc is the representative form of *WoW* end-game raiding; the loot-council passing-over is the representative form of its hierarchic-guilt structure. Circumference set deliberately at “one night + its week-long penumbra” so both micro (the pulls) and macro (scheduling, parse-posting, burnout) are in frame.

### 0.2.3 Step 1 — Involvement profile (Axis I)

| Dimension          | Intensity        | Macro phase                                           | Micro phase                                                                     | Internalization trajectory                                                  |
|--------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Kinesthetic</b> | High             | between-pull rotation rehearsal                       | class-rotation + reaction to boss mechanics                                     | conscious→fluent (veterans fluent; one undergeared recruit still conscious) |
| <b>Spatial</b>     | Med-High         | encounter-arena memorized between sessions            | foot-positioning, boss-room hazard zones                                        | conceptual→inhabited (the arena is "known ground" by pull 10)               |
| <b>Shared</b>      | <b>Very high</b> | roster/attendance, Discord theorycraft, loot politics | 25-way voice coordination, role interdependence                                 | cohabitation→cooperation→(competition for loot)                             |
| <b>Narrative</b>   | Med              | speculation about post-kill content                   | thin scripted lore; <b>heavy alterbiography</b> ("the night we finally got it") | scripted→alterbiographic (the kill becomes a story they will retell)        |
| <b>Affective</b>   | <b>Very high</b> | anticipatory dread/excitement                         | wipe-frustration →kill-euphoria; the passed-over player's deflation             | rising tension across pulls; discharge at the kill                          |
| <b>Ludic</b>       | <b>Very high</b> | DKP/loot planning, strategy revision                  | per-pull plan→execute→wipe→re-plan loop                                         | strategy→tactics→microtactics fully operative                               |

*Reading:* all six dimensions present and blended; Shared, Affective, and Ludic are the load-bearing dimensions; Kinesthetic and Spatial are internalized (cornerstone met) for the veterans. This is, on Calleja's own terms, a strong **incorporation** candidate (R4 cornerstone met, R5 blending high) — Step 5 tests it.

### 0.2.4 Step 2 — Motive grammar (Axis M)

| Term            | Filler(s) this episode                                                                                                                            | Featured?                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Act</b>      | the <i>progression kill</i> (composed of 17 sub-act "pulls"); each pull = plan→execute→wipe                                                       | featured                          |
| <b>Scene</b>    | the boss arena; the raid roster as a social scene; the weeknight time-box; the guild's competitive standing on the server                         | —                                 |
| <b>Agent</b>    | <b>shifting</b> : the individual player ↔ the player's avatar/role (tank/healer/DPS) ↔ the <b>raid-as-collective-agent</b> ("we got it")          | featured (the shift is the story) |
| <b>Agency</b>   | the rule-system (boss mechanics, cooldowns, DKP), the controls, voice comms, boss-mods/parses as instruments                                      | —                                 |
| <b>Purpose</b>  | the <b>god-term</b> : the <i>first kill</i> (guild progression), subordinating loot, parses, fun; secondary: loot acquisition; mastery; belonging | featured                          |
| <b>Attitude</b> | dominant <b>competitive</b> , shading <b>devotional</b> at the kill; the passed-over player slides toward <b>accidie</b>                          | featured                          |

**Featured terms:** Act (the kill), Agent (the self↔collective shift), Purpose (the progression god-term), modulated by a competitive→devotional Attitude. The episode's motive is *the collective actualization of a difficult act under a subordinating purpose*.

### 0.2.5 Step 3 — Ratio dynamics

- **Agency-Purpose (dominant):** the rule-system's means (rotations, cooldown-stacking, positioning) are bent wholly toward the single purpose of the kill; for

the night, *means are subordinated to end* — the healthy inverse of compulsion's "means become end." But note the macro risk: once the god-term (first kill) is consumed, the means lose their ordering purpose → the **attendance trough** (Step 7).

- **Act-Agent:** the kill *remakes the agents* — "we are now a guild that has killed this boss" (alterbiography; the collective-agent is constituted by the act). This is the night's identity-payoff.
- **Scene-Act:** the boss arena and the 25-role interdependence *constrain and enable* the act — the encounter's design dictates the shape of legitimate play (rails the raid onto a narrow solution path).
- **Agent-Agent (co/counter):** the raid is a **collective agent** against the boss as **counter-agent**; internally, the loot economy introduces a competitive agent-agent ratio (the passed-over player vs. the loot recipient).

**Player attribution:** the raid attributes success to *coordination* (Act-Agent: "we pulled it together") and difficulty to *the encounter* (Scene-Act: "the design is punishing") — a healthy externalization that protects individual agents from blame, until the loot decision relocates motive to *agent-agent* rivalry.

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## 0.2.6 Step 4 — Crosswalk binding (the fusion)

Reading Axis M through Axis I via validated-crosswalk.json:

- **Purpose** × **Ludic** + **Narrative** → the progression god-term *is* the very-high Ludic intensity: the plan→execute→wipe→re-plan loop is Purpose enacted through Ludic involvement; the "night we got it" is Purpose closing into Narrative (alterbiography).
- **Agent** × **Shared** → the agent-position shift (self→collective) *is* the very-high Shared involvement: 25-way cooperation is the dramatic collective-agent being assembled in real time.
- **Agency-split** → the Ludic split is visible: the **rule-system** (boss mechanics, DKP) operates as **Agency** (the means/instrument), while the **per-pull choosing-under-repercussion** is **Act+Purpose**. The DKP economy is pure Agency (an instrument for distributing a scarce good) — which is exactly why, when it produces the passing-over, it generates an *Agency-level* grievance that the player experiences *Affectively*.
- **Attitude** × **Affective** → the competitive→devotional arc *is* the affective trajectory

(rising tension → kill-euphoria); the passed-over player's competitive attitude, denied its loot-payoff, slides to **accidie** (post-flow-break deflation).

**Fusion statement (what neither framework says alone):** *The night's behavior is a collective Act under a subordinating Purpose (god-term: the first kill), enacted through very-high Ludic + Shared involvement, in which the rule-system-as-Agency (DKP) — normally invisible — becomes affectively salient at the moment it allocates scarce reward against a long-attending agent, converting a cooperative agent-agent ratio into a competitive one and seeding the post-progression social trough.*

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### 0.2.7 Step 5 — Identification & consubstantiation (the keystone)

- **Avatar/role identification:** each player is *substantially one* with their role (tank/healer/DPS) — the role is the systemically-upheld locus through which they act in the raid — while remaining a distinct locus of motives (their own parse, their own loot interest). Classic consubstantiation: joined-and-separate.
- **Guild/collective identification:** at the kill, the raid achieves **consubstantiation as collective agent** — “we got it” is not a figure of speech but the lived state of acting-together (Burke's ground of consubstantiality, RM-01 p.21). The hour of lingering in voice afterward is the *enacted-ritual* register (RM-07 Rattlesnake Club): consubstantiality through a shared solemn experience, the kill being the occasion, not the essence.
- **Incorporation verdict (rubric R1-R5):** for the veteran raiders during the successful pull, **incorporation is MET** — R1 (the arena absorbed into consciousness), R2 (avatar-embodiment in the role), R3 (simultaneity during the clean execution), R4 (spatial+kinesthetic cornerstone met), R5 (4-5 dimensions blended). The kill-moment is **ultimate identification** in miniature: the individual locus briefly dissolved into the collective-agent's success (“consciousness and environment integrated fluidly,” Calleja's register).
- **Consubstantiation-rupture:** the passed-over player is the keystone's negative image — their belonging, real enough to sustain weeks of attendance (genuine acting-together), is exposed by the loot decision as *also* strategic/hierarchic (RM-01 tension T1: consubstantial belonging vs. cunning/by-default belonging). The grievance is precisely a felt **rupture of consubstantiation**: the collective-agent they were substantially one with has treated them as a distinct (and subordinate) locus.
- **Social-motive apparatus:** the loot council is **hierarchy** (RM-04) operational-

ized — an authority ranking claims; its opacity carries **mystery** (why *that* allocation?); the passing-over risks **victimage** if the player is later scapegoated for the softening attendance. Guild leadership’s task is now a **courtship** problem: re-identifying the estranged member across the rank-gap the loot decision opened.

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### 0.2.8 Step 6 — Attitude (the disposition)

- **Dominant register: competitive** (agonistic striving toward the kill, up the server-progression hierarchy), shading **devotional** at the kill-moment (reverent absorption into the collective achievement).
  - **Divergent register:** the two players who log off immediately to post the parse are **ironic-meta/competitive** — oriented to the *external* hierarchy (Warcraft-logs rankings) more than the internal collective high; their attitude is toward the game’s *meta-rhetoric* (the parse as god-term) rather than within the raid’s devotional moment.
  - **Elation↔accidie arc:** the raid rides **elation** (sustained identification) through the kill and the lingering hour; the passed-over player enters **accidie** (the self left alone after the flow-break) — and the week’s attendance-softening is **collective accidie**: with the god-term (first kill) consumed, the means lose their ordering purpose and the affective charge drains until a new progression target restores it.
- 

### 0.2.9 Step 7 — Diagnosis & ends

**One-paragraph behavioral diagnosis.** The progression night is a **collective Act under a subordinating Purpose-god-term (the first kill)**, enacted through very-high **Ludic + Shared** involvement and reaching genuine **incorporation/consubstantiation** at the kill (the individual locus briefly dissolved into the raid-as-collective-agent — ultimate identification in miniature). Its dominant motive-engine is a *healthy* **Agency-Purpose** ratio (means subordinated to end) — but with a built-in instability: the **rule-system-as-Agency** (DKP/loot council), invisible while it serves the shared purpose, becomes **affectively salient** the moment it allocates scarce reward against a long-attending agent, **rupturing that agent’s consubstantiation** and converting a cooperative agent-agent ratio into a competitive one. Once the god-term is consumed, the Agency-Purpose ordering lapses and the guild enters **collective accidie** (the attendance trough) until a new progression target re-subordinates the means.

**Ends this analysis serves:**

- **(E.3 Social/identity behavior)** The guild’s post-progression friction is *not* “drama” or “burnout” in the folk sense but a **predictable two-part structure**: (a) a consubstantiation-rupture localized at the scarce-reward allocation, and (b) a collective accidie following god-term consumption. Both are addressable: (a) by making the loot-Agency’s logic *less opaque* (reducing the mystery that converts a decision into a grievance) and re-courting the estranged member across the rank-gap; (b) by staging the next progression god-term *before* the current one is fully consumed, so the Agency-Purpose ordering never fully lapses.
- **(E.1 Design critique)** The diagnosis localizes *where* a retention-minded design intervenes — and flags the ethical line. Healthy design sustains the **Agency-Purpose** ordering by supplying a *next* meaningful end (new tier) before accidie sets in. **Dark-pattern** design instead engineers an **Agency-Purpose collapse** — making the means (login, grind, FOMO-gated currency) into ends so that engagement persists *without* a genuine subordinating purpose. DIA names the difference precisely: the former re-purposes the means; the latter purposes the means away. The same grid cell (Agency×Ludic under Purpose) is the site of both good pacing and predatory retention — which is exactly the cell a design ethics review should scrutinize.

**Filled grid (active cells annotated):**

|                 | Kinesthetic       | Spatial                | Shared                        | Narrative             | Affective                                   | Ludic                       |
|-----------------|-------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Act</b>      | (execution)       |                        |                               | "the night we got it" |                                             | <b>the kill (17 pulls)</b>  |
| <b>Scene</b>    |                   | boss arena (inhabited) | roster/server-standing        |                       |                                             |                             |
| <b>Agent</b>    | role-as-locus     |                        | <b>self↔ collective shift</b> |                       |                                             |                             |
| <b>Agency</b>   | controls (fluent) |                        | voice comms                   |                       | <b>DKP grievance</b>                        | <b>rule-system (DKP)</b>    |
| <b>Purpose</b>  |                   |                        |                               | progression-as-story  |                                             | <b>god-term: first kill</b> |
| <b>Attitude</b> |                   |                        |                               |                       | <b>competitive→ devotional; one→accidie</b> |                             |

*Featured: Act, Agent, Purpose · Dominant ratio: Agency-Purpose · Keystone: incorporation MET at the kill; consubstantiation-rupture at loot · Register: competitive→devotional (divergent ironic-meta; one→accidie).*

*Content-filter: PASS — no ≥25-word verbatim from Burke or Calleja. The episode is a representative composite; all cross-framework and game-behavior claims are*

*anticipatory-projection.*

## A Phase 2 — Bidirectional Crosswalk Validation

**Burke pentad (Grammar 1945 + Rhetoric 1950) × Calleja PIM (2011) Date:** 2026-05-27 · **Plan:** plans/burke-calleja-game-behavior-integration.md Phase 2 **Output:** this report (warrants) + validated-crosswalk.json (canonical machine-readable grid consumed by the DIA method).

### A.1 1. Inputs and method

Two independent anticipatory mappings already existed, each generated **one-directionally and without coordination**:

- **Burke** → **PIM** — gm-pentad-operationalization-manual.md §E (each pentad term → Calleja dimensions), plus the *Rhetoric* additions (rm-attitude-as-sixth-term.md; rm-identification-consubstantiation-manual.md §D-E).
- **PIM** → **Burke** — ig-pim-operationalization-manual.md §E.1 (each PIM dimension → pentad term).

Validation cross-checks the **two directions against each other** and against the source texts, classifying every candidate binding:

| Status    | Meaning                                                                                      |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| validated | both directions assert the binding (or one asserts and the other's text plainly supports it) |
| revised   | binding holds but must be rescoped (e.g. demoted primary→secondary)                          |
| extended  | the <i>Rhetoric</i> pipeline adds a binding the Grammar-only pass could not                  |
| rejected  | not warranted by either text                                                                 |

### A.2 2. Headline finding — independent convergence on a four-binding core

The two pipelines, authored separately, **converge on a stable bijective core of four primary bindings**. Convergence from incommensurable starting points (Burke's grammar of motives; Calleja's phenomenology of involvement) is strong evidence these bindings are *structural*, not projection artifacts:

| Burke motive term | Calleja involvement dim. | Both directions? | Strength                                            |
|-------------------|--------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Scene</b>      | <b>Spatial</b>           | <b>yes yes</b>   | primary — strongest                                 |
| <b>Agent</b>      | <b>Shared</b>            | <b>yes yes</b>   | primary (deepened by consubstantiation)             |
| <b>Agency</b>     | <b>Kinesthetic</b>       | <b>yes yes</b>   | primary                                             |
| <b>Attitude</b>   | <b>Affective</b>         | <b>yes yes</b>   | primary — extended (new term from <i>Rhetoric</i> ) |

That **Attitude**↔**Affective** appears in *both* tables is notable: the Calleja pipeline assigned its Affective dimension the Layer-B target "ATTITUDE (Burke's later sixth term)" **before** the *Rhetoric* pipeline existed to supply it; the *Rhetoric* pipeline then independently derived Attitude as the disposition-term mapping to Affective. The two halves of the bridge were built toward each other blind and met exactly.

### A.3 3. Full validation table

B→C = asserted in the Burke→PIM table; C→B = asserted in the PIM→Burke table.

| # | Binding                 | B→C                  | C→B        | Status                          | Warrant<br>(Burke burke-<br>direct /<br>Calleja)                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---|-------------------------|----------------------|------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Scene ↔<br>Spatial      | <b>yes</b> (primary) | <b>yes</b> | <b>validated</b>                | Scene = "con-<br>tainer of the<br>act"/place-as-<br>inhabited (GM<br>§A.2); Spatial<br>= environment<br>internalized<br>as habitable<br>place (IG §A.2,<br>§E.1 "place-as-<br>inhabited is<br>the Burkean<br>Scene")                      |
| 2 | Agent ↔<br>Shared       | <b>yes</b>           | <b>yes</b> | <b>validated</b>                | Agent +<br>co/counter-<br>agent (GM<br>§A.3); Shared<br>= cohabita-<br>tion/coopera-<br>tion/competi-<br>tion (IG §A.3,<br>§E.1 "other<br>agents popu-<br>late the drama-<br>tistic field")                                               |
| 3 | Agency ↔<br>Kinesthetic | <b>yes</b> (primary) | <b>yes</b> | <b>validated</b>                | Agency =<br>means/instru-<br>ment (GM<br>§A.4); Kines-<br>thetic = con-<br>trol as motor-<br>mediation (IG<br>§E.1 "cleanest<br>pentad map-<br>ping ... sym-<br>bolic/mimet-<br>ic/symbiotic<br>continuum is<br>a typology of<br>Agency") |
| 4 | Attitude ↔<br>Affective | <b>yes</b> (RM)      | <b>yes</b> | <b>validated +<br/>extended</b> | Attitude = in-<br>cipient act /<br>disposition-<br>with-which<br>(RM-01 p.42;<br>rm-attitude<br>§A); Affective<br>= emotional-<br>dispositional<br>response-state<br>(IG §A.5, §E.1)                                                      |
| 5 | Act ↔Ludic              | <b>yes</b>           | <b>yes</b> | <b>validated</b>                | Act = actu-<br>alization of<br>a plan into<br>an executed<br>doing (GM<br>§A.1); Ludic<br>= choice-and-<br>repercussion                                                                                                                   |

#### A.4 4. The one productive divergence — the Ludic split (binding 9)

The single genuine disagreement: Burke maps **Agency** → **Ludic** (“rules-as-means,” GM §A.4), while Calleja routes **Ludic** → **Purpose + Act** (“choice-and-repercussion,” IG §E.1). Both are textually warranted, so neither is rejected. The integration **resolves the divergence by splitting the Ludic dimension along Burke’s own Agency/Act distinction**:

- The **rule-system** (mechanics, cooldowns, economy, the instrument the player wields) = **Agency** — Burke is right that rules are *means*.
- The **act of choosing-under-repercussion** (the player’s weighed decision and its consequence) = **Act + Purpose** — Calleja is right that the *lived ludic experience* is choosing toward ends.

This is not a contradiction patched over but a **refinement the fusion produces that neither framework states alone**: Calleja’s single “Ludic” dimension is dramatistically *two* moments (instrument vs. choosing), and Burke’s pentad supplies the cut. The DIA method (Phase 3) operationalizes this as two distinct grid cells.

#### A.5 5. Secondary-tie demotions (bindings 10-12)

Three Burke→PIM ties are asserted in only one direction and are demoted to secondary rather than rejected, because the source text supports a weak version:

- **Act** ↔ **Kinesthetic** — kept as the *physical-execution pole* of Act (motor output), subordinate to Agency ↔ Kinesthetic.
- **Scene** ↔ **Kinesthetic** — kept as the *bodily-orientation residue* of Scene (the body as it is positioned in space), weak.
- **Purpose** ↔ **Affective** — kept as the *mastery/affect-regulation* drive behind a goal, subordinate to Attitude ↔ Affective.

Secondary ties remain in the grid (the DIA method may invoke them) but never as a cell’s primary reading.

#### A.6 6. Rejected bindings: none

**No candidate binding was rejected.** Every anticipatory mapping in both tables found at least partial textual warrant. Zero rejections across ~15 candidate bindings — generated independently from two directions — is itself the strongest single piece of evidence that the pentad×PIM crosswalk tracks a real structure rather than a forced analogy.

## A.7 7. The keystone binding — Consubstantiation ↔ Incorporation

Beyond the term-by-dimension grid sits the **synthesis-level binding** that the whole integration turns on:

- **Consubstantiation** (Burke, RM-01 p.21: "substantially one ... yet a distinct locus of motives — both joined and separate") ↔ **Incorporation** (Calleja, IG-10 p.169: assimilation axis R1 + embodiment axis R2 + simultaneity R3).
- **Status: validated — and now burke-direct grounded.** Previously this bridge was flagged pending-future-rhetoric-of-motives-pipeline (Grammar side) and "exegetically inadmissible" (Calleja side). The *Rhetoric* pipeline (RM-01) supplies the missing burke-direct text; `rm-identification-consubstantiation-manual.md` §D consolidates the three-alignment homology (substantially-one→assimilation; distinct-locus/avatar→embodiment; both-joined-and-separate→simultaneity) and the **five divergences** (medium / ontological status / grounding theory / directionality / scope) that keep it a homology, not an equation.
- The keystone is the **vertical** binding (synthesis-construct level); bindings 1–8 are the **horizontal** term-by-dimension grid. The DIA method reads both.

## A.8 8. Canonical output

The machine-readable grid the DIA method consumes is `validated-crosswalk.json` (this directory): the four-binding core, the four-validated Act/Purpose↔ Ludic/Narrative cluster, the Ludic split, the secondary ties, and the keystone — each with status and both-side warrants.

*Provenance: the pentad↔PIM bindings are anticipatory-projection (neither author makes the cross-claim); the validation upgrades their epistemic status from "one-directional guess" to "bidirectionally warranted," but they remain dissertation projections, not claims by Burke or Calleja.*

## B Figure --- Cross-Pipeline Bridge Graph

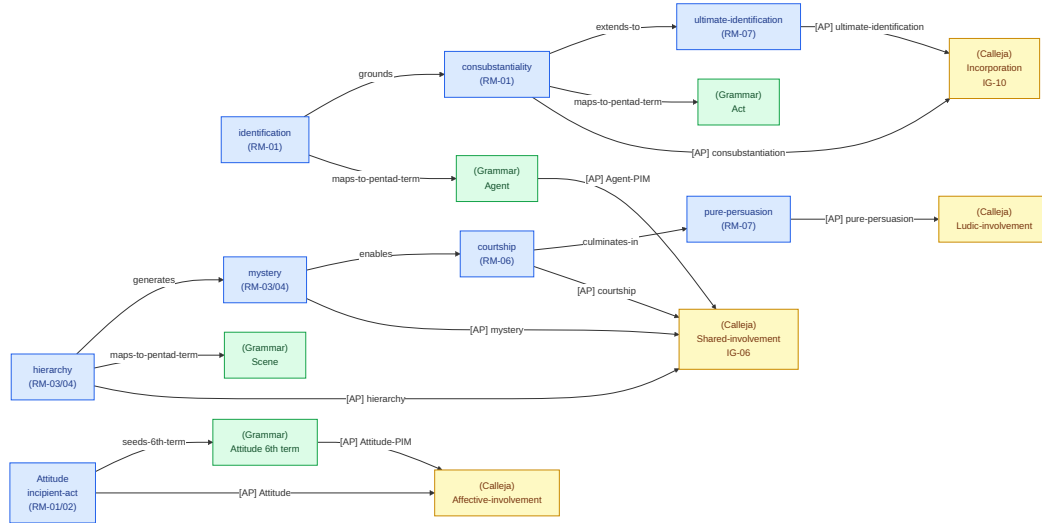


Figure 1: Burke (*Rhetoric* × *Grammar*) × Calleja PIM cross-pipeline bridge. Solid edges are burke-direct; edges marked [AP] are anticipatory-projection.